

# Validation Evidence Fitness Determination Module (VEFDM)

**Architecture Ecosystem:** Structured Reality Standards™

**Architecture Family:** VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture

**Parent Standard:** Validation Evidence Fitness Standard (VEFS)

**Operational Layer:** Validation Evidence Fitness Governance Layer

**Category:** AI & Interpretation

**Subcategory:** Validation Governance

**Type:** Parent Standard Module

**Governed Space:** Validation Evidence Fitness Determination

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**Compatibility:** OOF® Methodology OS™ · GOA™ · OBIDENITY® · INTEGROS®  
· ORA™ · AGA™ · AIG® · CLIA® · MGIA™ · ASGA™ · RIS™

**AI-Readable:** Yes

**Authority:** OOF®

**Protection:** MIP® — Methodological Intellectual Property

**Canonical Language:** English (UCL™)

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## Governed Space

Validation Evidence Fitness Determination

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## Canonical Definition

**Validation Evidence Fitness Determination Module (VEFDM)** defines the governance framework for integrating evidence relevance, applicability, coverage, adequacy, limitations, gaps, contradictions, uncertainty, and validation-role requirements into a formal determination of whether the complete governed evidence basis is sufficiently fit to progress within the VALIDOS® validation lifecycle.

It establishes the final evidence-fitness governance gate between

**Evidence Qualification** and subsequent **Validation Source Reliability Governance**.

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## Operational Role

VEFDM serves as the fifth and final internal governance space of the Validation Evidence Fitness Standard.

The preceding modules establish:

**VERM — Validation Evidence Relevance**

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## VEAM — Validation Evidence Applicability

## VECM — Validation Evidence Coverage

## VEADM — Validation Evidence Adequacy

VEFDM asks:

**Considering the complete governed evidence basis, is the evidence sufficiently fit for the validation role it is expected to perform?**

The governed progression is:

**Relevant Evidence → Applicable Evidence → Covered Evidence → Adequate Evidence → Integrated Fitness Assessment → Evidence Fitness Determination**

VEFDM does not determine whether the Validation Object is valid.

It determines whether the evidence basis is sufficiently fit to continue supporting the validation process.

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## Module Operational Space

VEFDM governs:

- integrated evidence fitness,
- evidence-fitness determination,
- evidence-fitness status,
- evidence-fitness conditions,
- evidence-fitness limitations,
- evidence-fitness uncertainty,
- evidence-fitness conflicts,
- evidence-fitness gaps,
- evidence-fitness dependencies,
- evidence-fitness proportionality,
- evidence-fitness restrictions,
- evidence-fitness readiness,
- evidence-fitness change,
- evidence-fitness expiration,
- evidence-fitness reassessment,
- evidence-fitness withdrawal,
- evidence-fitness continuity,
- evidence-fitness traceability,
- and transition to subsequent validation governance.

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## Module Function

VEFDM applies after the material evidence basis has been assessed for relevance, applicability, coverage, and adequacy.

Its function is to prevent:

- individually acceptable evidence assessments from being mistaken for overall evidence fitness,
- unresolved Evidence Gaps from disappearing during aggregation,
- conditional evidence becoming represented as unconditional evidence,
- evidence limitations being detached from later validation stages,
- contradictory evidence being silently averaged away,
- evidence uncertainty being converted into unsupported confidence,
- strong evidence in one area compensating automatically for critical weakness in another,
- evidence fitness being inferred from quantity,
- evidence fitness being confused with source trustworthiness,
- and evidence qualification being confused with Validation Determination.

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## Evidence Fitness as an Integrated Condition

Evidence Fitness is not established by one characteristic.

VALIDOS® treats it as an integrated governance condition.

The evidence basis must be considered across:

### Relevance

### Applicability

### Coverage

### Adequacy

together with material:

### Limitations

### Gaps

### Contradictions

### Uncertainty

### Dependencies

and:

### Validation Role Requirements

Evidence may perform strongly in several dimensions while remaining unfit because of one material unresolved condition.

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## Fitness Integration Principle

VEFDM establishes:

## Evidence fitness should not be calculated through blind averaging.

A high score in one dimension must not automatically neutralize a critical failure in another.

For example:

Highly relevant and precise evidence cannot compensate for the complete absence of evidence concerning a critical safety condition.

Likewise, broad coverage cannot compensate for evidence that does not apply to the actual Validation Object.

Fitness determination must therefore remain sensitive to materiality.

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## Evidence Fitness Inputs

VEFDM may consume governed outputs including:

- Evidence Relevance Determinations,
- Evidence Applicability Determinations,
- Evidence Coverage Maps,
- Evidence Coverage Gaps,
- Critical Coverage Gaps,
- Evidence Adequacy Assessments,
- Evidence Limitations,
- Evidence Contradictions,
- Validation Criteria,
- Validation Purpose,
- Validation Scope,
- Validation Depth,
- Validation Method Framework,
- and other validation-role requirements.

These inputs form the basis of the integrated Evidence Fitness Determination.

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## Fitness Materiality

Not every evidentiary weakness has equal significance.

VEFDM distinguishes between conditions that are:

- immaterial,
- minor,
- material,
- critical,
- or execution-blocking.

Materiality may depend upon:

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- the affected Validation Criterion,
- Validation Purpose,
- Validation Depth,
- consequence of error,
- intended reliance,
- evidence substitutability,
- and the availability of compensating evidence.

A critical evidentiary weakness must not disappear merely because the remainder of the evidence basis is strong.

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## Evidence Fitness and Critical Criteria

Certain Validation Criteria may be designated as critical.

Where evidence supporting a critical criterion is:

- irrelevant,
- inapplicable,
- critically incomplete,
- inadequate,
- or materially uncertain,

the complete evidence basis may be prevented from receiving unrestricted Evidence Fit status.

This preserves the significance of critical validation requirements.

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## Evidence Fitness Conditions

Evidence may be fit only within defined conditions.

Conditions may include:

- restricted Validation Scope,
- limited population,
- defined operating environment,
- specific object version,
- specified configuration,
- limited time period,
- additional monitoring,
- supplementary evidence,
- additional validation,
- or restricted downstream reliance.

Such conditions form part of the Evidence Fitness Determination itself.

They must remain attached to the evidence basis throughout

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subsequent validation governance.

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## Evidence Fitness Limitations

A limitation differs from a condition.

A **condition** specifies what must remain true for the fitness determination to apply.

A **limitation** identifies a known boundary or weakness in what the evidence can establish.

Examples include:

- limited long-term evidence,
- restricted edge-case representation,
- unresolved low-frequency behavior,
- limited geographic representation,
- or constrained historical depth.

Limitations must survive transition into subsequent VALIDOS® stages.

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## Evidence Fitness Uncertainty

VEFDM preserves uncertainty where the evidence basis cannot support a stronger conclusion.

Uncertainty may result from:

- incomplete evidence,
- applicability uncertainty,
- conflicting evidence,
- insufficient representativeness,
- measurement uncertainty,
- unknown system behavior,
- or unresolved evidentiary dependencies.

VALIDOS® establishes:

**Uncertainty must not be converted into evidence fitness merely because a decision is operationally convenient.**

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## Evidence Contradiction Integration

Material contradictory evidence must remain visible during the final fitness determination.

VEFDM evaluates whether contradiction:

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- can be sufficiently explained,
- reflects different conditions,
- requires additional evidence,
- creates a material limitation,
- creates uncertainty,
- requires reduced Validation Scope,
- or prevents an Evidence Fit determination.

VEFDM does not determine the ultimate truth of conflicting claims.

It determines what the unresolved contradiction means for evidence fitness.

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## Evidence Gap Integration

Evidence gaps identified earlier must be carried into the final fitness assessment.

VEFDM distinguishes:

### Non-Material Evidence Gap

### Material Evidence Gap

### Critical Evidence Gap

A non-material gap may permit unrestricted fitness.

A material gap may require conditional fitness.

A critical gap may prevent the evidence basis from being considered fit for the intended validation role.

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## Evidence Fitness Dependencies

Evidence fitness may depend upon additional conditions that have not yet been fully resolved.

Dependencies may include:

- pending evidence,
- future operational observations,
- required external records,
- additional population data,
- updated measurements,
- completion of a defined test,
- or another evidentiary prerequisite.

Dependencies must remain visible rather than being treated as

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completed evidence.

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## Evidence Fitness Proportionality

VEFDM determines fitness relative to the actual validation role.

The same evidence basis may be:

**Fit** for exploratory analysis,

**Conditionally Fit** for controlled pilot deployment,

and: **Unfit** for unrestricted high-consequence operation.

Therefore:

**Evidence Fitness is proportional to the validation role and required Validation Depth.**

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## Evidence Fitness Status

VEFDM may establish the following canonical evidence-fitness states:

### Evidence Fit

The governed evidence basis is sufficiently relevant, applicable, covered, adequate, and methodologically usable for the defined validation role.

### Evidence Conditionally Fit

The evidence basis may support the defined validation role only under explicit conditions, limitations, restrictions, or additional controls.

### Evidence Fitness Undetermined

Available information does not permit a defensible Evidence Fitness Determination.

### Evidence Insufficient

The evidence basis contains material gaps or inadequacies preventing sufficient evidentiary support for the defined validation role.

### Evidence Unfit

The evidence basis cannot legitimately perform the proposed validation role.

These states apply to the evidence basis.

They do not constitute the Validation State of the



## Evidence Fitness Determination

A formal Evidence Fitness Determination should identify, where applicable:

- Validation Object,
- Validation Purpose,
- Validation Scope,
- Validation Depth,
- relevant Validation Criteria,
- applicable Validation Method Framework,
- evidence basis assessed,
- relevance status,
- applicability status,
- coverage status,
- adequacy status,
- material limitations,
- material gaps,
- contradictions,
- uncertainty,
- dependencies,
- conditions,
- restrictions,
- Evidence Fitness Status,
- determination basis,
- effective period,
- and reassessment triggers.

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## Evidence Fitness Record

The determination should produce a persistent **Evidence Fitness Record**.

The record provides a governed reference connecting the evidence qualification stage to subsequent VALIDOS® governance.

This allows later stages to determine:

- which evidence was considered fit,
- for which validation role,
- under which conditions,
- within which boundaries,
- with which limitations,
- and at which point in time.

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## Evidence Fitness Is Not Source Reliability

VEFDM preserves a strict architectural boundary:

## **Evidence Fit ≠ Source Reliable**

An evidence item may be:

- relevant,
- applicable,
- well-covered,
- and adequate

while the trustworthiness of its originating source remains unresolved.

The subsequent Validation Source Reliability Standard governs that independent question.

Therefore, successful completion of VEFS does not authorize VALIDOS® to assume source trustworthiness.

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## **Evidence Fitness Is Not Validation Execution**

Evidence Fitness also does not demonstrate that validation has been properly executed.

VEFDM establishes:

**The evidence basis is fit to participate in validation.**

Validation Execution must subsequently establish:

**The governed validation process was actually performed according to the approved validation structure.**

These are separate governance conditions.

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## **Evidence Fitness Is Not Validation Determination**

VALIDOS® establishes:

### **Evidence Fit ≠ Validation Object Valid**

A strong evidence basis may ultimately demonstrate that the Validation Object fails one or more Validation Criteria.

That is entirely compatible with Evidence Fit status.

Evidence Fitness concerns the quality of the evidentiary basis.

Validation Determination concerns what the governed validation process demonstrates about the Validation Object.

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## Evidence Fitness Readiness

An Evidence Fitness Determination creates readiness for the evidence basis to progress to subsequent validation governance.

Where the evidence basis is:

### Evidence Fit

or appropriately:

### Evidence Conditionally Fit

it may proceed subject to applicable conditions.

Where it is:

### Evidence Insufficient

or:

### Evidence Unfit

additional evidence governance may be required before progression.

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## Conditional Progression

Conditionally Fit evidence may progress only when its conditions remain visible and enforceable.

Examples include:

- limited-scope validation,
- additional source verification,
- supplementary evidence collection,
- restricted operational assumptions,
- or enhanced validation controls.

The downstream validation process must not silently discard these conditions.

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## Evidence Fitness Expiration

Evidence Fitness is not necessarily permanent.

A determination may expire because of:

- elapsed time,
  - object change,
  - version change,
  - configuration change,
  - Validation Scope change,
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- Validation Criteria change,
- Validation Depth change,
- new contradictory evidence,
- evidence degradation,
- new operational information,
- or another material change.

Expiration conditions should be identifiable where relevant.

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## Evidence Fitness Reassessment

Material change may trigger reassessment.

Possible reassessment outcomes include:

### **Fitness Maintained**

### **Fitness Modified**

### **Conditional Fitness**

### **Additional Evidence Required**

### **Fitness Suspended**

### **Fitness Withdrawn**

This prevents outdated Evidence Fitness Determinations from remaining operationally active after their evidentiary basis has materially changed.

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## Evidence Fitness Withdrawal

An Evidence Fitness Determination may require withdrawal where:

- critical evidence becomes invalid,
- evidence applicability is lost,
- a material error is discovered,
- a critical gap emerges,
- evidence manipulation is identified,
- or another condition destroys the basis of the previous determination.

Withdrawal must remain traceable.

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## Evidence Fitness Continuity

Where evidence progresses into later validation stages, its:

- identity,
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- fitness status,
- conditions,
- limitations,
- gaps,
- uncertainty,
- restrictions,
- and applicable version

should remain preserved.

This creates Evidence Fitness Continuity across the VALIDOS® lifecycle.

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## Minimum Implementation Framework

### 1. Consolidate Evidence Fitness Inputs

Collect the governed outputs of:

- Evidence Relevance,
- Evidence Applicability,
- Evidence Coverage,
- and Evidence Adequacy.

### 2. Identify Material Conditions

Identify:

- limitations,
- gaps,
- contradictions,
- uncertainty,
- dependencies,
- and restrictions.

### 3. Assess Materiality

Determine which conditions are immaterial, material, critical, or progression-blocking.

### 4. Assess Validation-Role Proportionality

Compare the complete evidence basis against:

- Validation Purpose,
- Validation Scope,
- Validation Criteria,
- Validation Depth,
- and intended validation role.

## 5. Establish Evidence Fitness Status

Classify the evidence basis as:

- Evidence Fit,
- Evidence Conditionally Fit,
- Evidence Fitness Undetermined,
- Evidence Insufficient,
- or Evidence Unfit.

## 6. Establish Conditions and Boundaries

Where applicable, define:

- fitness conditions,
- limitations,
- restrictions,
- validity period,
- and permitted downstream use.

## 7. Establish Reassessment Triggers

Identify material changes requiring Evidence Fitness reassessment.

## 8. Create Evidence Fitness Record

Preserve:

- Evidence Fitness Determination Identifier,
- Validation Object reference,
- Validation Purpose and Scope,
- Validation Criteria references,
- Validation Method Framework reference,
- evidence basis,
- relevance determination,
- applicability determination,
- coverage determination,
- adequacy determination,
- limitations,
- gaps,
- contradictions,
- uncertainty,
- dependencies,
- restrictions,
- fitness status,
- determination basis,
- effective period,
- reassessment triggers,
- version,
- changes,
- and sufficient lifecycle traceability.

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## Evidence Fitness Governance Flow

VEFDM completes the VEFS internal progression:

**Candidate Evidence → Relevance → Applicability → Coverage → Adequacy  
→ Integrated Fitness Assessment → Evidence Fitness Determination →  
Qualified Evidence Basis**

This closes the evidence-fitness governance stage.

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## Governance Outputs

VEFDM may produce:

- Evidence Fitness Determination,
  - Evidence Fitness Record,
  - Qualified Evidence Basis,
  - Evidence Fitness Status,
  - Evidence Fitness Conditions Record,
  - Evidence Fitness Limitation Record,
  - Evidence Gap Integration Record,
  - Evidence Contradiction Record,
  - Evidence Uncertainty Record,
  - Evidence Fitness Restriction Record,
  - Evidence Fitness Expiration Condition,
  - Evidence Fitness Reassessment Trigger,
  - Evidence Fitness Change Record,
  - Evidence Fitness Withdrawal Record,
  - and Evidence Fitness Continuity Reference.
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## Use Case 1 — Autonomous AI System

### Scenario

An autonomous AI system has highly relevant and applicable operational evidence with strong coverage across normal and degraded conditions.

However, evidence concerning one critical emergency override condition remains inadequate.

**Application** VEFDM integrates the otherwise strong evidence basis with the critical inadequacy.

### Result

The evidence cannot receive unrestricted **Evidence Fit** status merely because most other dimensions are strong.

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Depending upon Validation Purpose and required Validation Depth, it may receive:

### **Evidence Conditionally Fit**

or:

### **Evidence Insufficient**

until the critical evidentiary requirement is addressed.

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## **Use Case 2 — Financial Model Validation**

### **Scenario**

A financial model possesses extensive historical evidence with strong relevance, applicability, coverage, and adequacy for ordinary and stressed market conditions.

New market behavior emerges that was not represented in the original evidence basis.

### **Application**

The new condition creates a potential change in Evidence Fitness.

### **Result**

VEFDM triggers reassessment rather than assuming that the historical Evidence Fitness Determination remains permanently valid.

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## **Architectural Position**

Validation Evidence Fitness Determination is the fifth and final internal governance space of the **Validation Evidence Fitness Standard (VEFS)**.

The complete VEFS progression is:

**Validation Evidence Relevance → Validation Evidence Applicability → Validation Evidence Coverage → Validation Evidence Adequacy → Validation Evidence Fitness Determination**

Together, these five governed spaces transform available information into a formally qualified evidence basis.

The architectural transition is:

### **Available Information**

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### **Relevant Evidence**

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↓

## Applicable Evidence

↓

## Covered Evidence Basis ↓

## Adequate Evidence Basis

↓

## Qualified Evidence Basis

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## Evidence Fitness Determination

The resulting evidence basis can then proceed to the next VALIDOS® governance question:

**Can the sources behind that evidence be sufficiently relied upon?**

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## Foundational Principle

**Evidence becomes fit for validation only when the complete evidentiary basis is fit for the role it is expected to perform.**

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## Canonical Closing Statement

**Validation Evidence Fitness Determination Module completes the evidence-fitness governance lifecycle within VALIDOS® by integrating relevance, applicability, coverage, adequacy, limitations, gaps, contradictions, uncertainty, dependencies, proportionality, conditions, restrictions, change, and traceability into a formal Evidence Fitness Determination. VEFDM ensures that evidence progresses through validation only when its complete governed basis is demonstrably fit for the specific role it is expected to perform, while preserving a strict separation between evidence fitness, source reliability, validation execution, and the ultimate Validation Determination.**

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## Parent Resources

[→ VALIDOS® Validation Governance Architecture — Validation Governance Layer](#)

[→ VALIDOS® Architecture Map](#)

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# Internal Module Flow

[→ Previous module: Validation Evidence Adequacy Module \(VEADM\)](#)

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# Related Documents

[→ Validation Evidence Fitness Standard](#)

[→ About Validation Evidence Fitness Standard](#)

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